

Sambucus nigra · Adoxaceae

Elderberry

Slow medicine. Steady protection.



Elderberry Syrup

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup dried elderberries (*Sambucus nigra*)
- 4 cups water
- ½ cup raw honey (added AFTER cooling)
- Optional: 1 thumb fresh ginger
- Medium saucepan + 16 oz amber glass bottle

METHOD

1. Measure ½ cup dried berries + 4 cups water into saucepan. (Optional: add ginger.)
2. Bring to boil, reduce to LOW simmer.
3. Simmer 30-45 min UNCOVERED until liquid reduces to 1 cup (DECOCTION).
4. Cool to 104°F (40°C) so honey enzymes survive. Strain.
5. Add ½ cup raw honey (1:1). Stir dissolved.
6. Bottle in 16 oz amber glass. Label: MADE Wk 1 · OPEN Wk 9 · USE WITHIN 8 WKS OF OPENING. Refrigerate. Write hypothesis in garden journal.

Vovó says:

Slow medicine builds slow trust. Simmer with patience.

SAFETY:

Adult handles the simmering pot. Raw berries/stems/leaves are TOXIC (cyanogenic glycosides) — only cooked ripe BLACK berries are safe. Confirm species: *Sambucus nigra* (not *S. racemosa*, red elder).

You are not your own; you were bought with a price — therefore glorify God in your body.

1 COR 6:19-20 (NASB)

CHANT: ELDERBERRY — SEE WEEK 1.